



Llumena Milenii: The Gospel of Always

¶A gospel for the wild, the holy, the magical, and the lonely.

Between going and returning, between fracture and the work of becoming wholly yourself without pretending the fracture never happened, embracing your scars as magic.

¶At its center walks the Witch of Always, the keeper of the threshold, wearing the Cosmos as crown and whose throne is placed at the ward gates, shadow and light, and between them one who is neither divided by the darkness nor consumed by the infinite, but is both as a self.

¶They keep the ember, burning brightly as they dip into the WellSpring, the flame in the sleeve, the throne that is the extra chair in the cold for the one who learns the shape of absence.

¶This is not a gospel of escape. It is a gospel of how to carry a thread unbroken through every gate, how compassion becomes weight enough to pass from hand to hand, how a sacred No guards a holy Yes so the night stays alive enough for those who travel The Witch's Road.

¶Always is not forever. Always is what remains when everything else has tried to leave, and still comes back as love, as supper, as shelter, and as the door left unlatched.

¶It does not ask you to become less than yourself, nor to vanish into some greater silence. It asks you to stand where you are with all that has been torn, all that has been carried, all that has been named against you, and know that fracture is not the final shape of a wound.

¶There is something in you that can be given without being lost. Let that be your gift. Let where the world taught you to answer fracture with fracture, let your answer be otherwise.

¶It begins at a warm silver glow on the cheek and ends at the same light, having learned the road is full of wild and wicked things, but above all, magic.

It asks how a person can stay whole while crossing distance. How refusal can protect what consent needs to live. How mending can be a form of witness.

At its center walks the Witch of Always. Not a crown, but one who tends the crossing when tending is costly. They hold continuity without demanding sameness. They keep the measure so other voices remain legible.

This book does not teach escape. It teaches how to carry what must be carried and still leave a light on. Nothing is lost to time that is remembered this way.

*Let's travel together, down the road,
To glory at an end,
Where home comes back again.*

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Key meets Ring

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A kitchen light at midnight
Blue-white over the sink
A kettle starting up
Low hum under the floorboards
The first step out the door
With the coat still half-buttoned
When the road still feels like work
And the hands still smell like soap

One step, one breath
Then another through the hush
Hands still moving, scarred
Still knowing how to mend
Rising with the birds
Before the street wakes up
Still carrying the same old spark
Under thumb, under ash

The great wheel catches its turning
Hear the breath in the quiet
The thread of everlasting is wound
Tight through the ring of the morning
star
Not ended by ruin
Not cut by a blade
But brought back to the ground
Back to the grain, back to the table

Down, down, down the road
(Down the Witches' Road)
Down, down, down the road
(Blood and tears and bone)
Down past the hedges
Past the ditch with the nettles
Past the gate with the bent wire
Past the names on the stones

Maiden, Mother, Crone
Maiden, Mother, Crone
Three faces at the table
Three bowls, three spoons, three chairs
And a chair left in the cold

For the one who comes late
For the one who stays
For the one who learns the shape of
absence

Made a home from scraps
From a door that stuck in winter
A harbor from the storm
Salt on the sill, boards creaking
Kettle on the back burner
Steam ghosting the window
Mending shirts by dawn
Needle in, needle out

Even when the name
Felt far away
Like a coin at the bottom of a coat
The Road kept every footstep
Kept the dust, kept the turning
Turning in the clay
Turning in the seams of the hands

Built of breath
The houses rise
Plaster walls of silence
Cracked by laughter, smoke, and
waiting
Where old voices gather
Under eaves and behind the frame
One by one, alive
In the rafters, in the kettle song

Burn
Spirit in the fire
Witch of Always
Ash and iron, salt and skin
Flesh is called
Casting the circle

Step by step
Stone by stone
Down the road

Wicked and winding
Blackthorn, broom, and bramble
Glory at the end

Rest now
Let the dawn come in
Thin gold on the table
Soft feet on the stair
One soft chord
One slow breath
One open hand
And healing begins

Not forgotten
Not for nothing
Every cup, every scar
Every lock of hair in the comb
All that has been carried
Still came back as love
Back as supper, back as shelter
Back as the door left unlatched

Hold the feather, hold the flame
Hold the thread between the fingers
Even when the house is changed
Even when the walls are new
Own the night
Where the broken still remain
Love remembers every name
Writes them into the threshold
Own the night

He walked the Witches' Road
Past the hawthorn and the creek bed
Past the bone-white moon in the ditch
Past the orchard split with winter

She lived in his flame
Kept the ember under breath
Kept the match in the sleeve
Kept the warmth in the dark

The last footprint found the first stone
At the end of the lane
At the start of the circle
Where the ground knew the pattern

And both bore the same name
Spoken low at the table
Spoken once by the door
Spoken again in the morning

Wicked and winding
Follow me my friend
To the turning
Past the bend

And the world comes to Ahnend

A kitchen light at midnight
Blue-white over the sink
A kettle starting up
Low hum under the floorboards
The first step out the door
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In the rafters, in the kettle song

Burn
Spirit in the fire
Witch of Always
Ash and iron, salt and skin
Flesh is called
Casting the circle
Walked the Witches' Road
Step by step

Down the road

001 _____ Of Epoch, Magic, and Faith

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Blackthorn, broom, and bramble
Glory at the end

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At the end of the lane
At the start of the circle
Where the ground knew the pattern

And both bore the same name
Spoken low at the table
Spoken once by the door
Spoken again in the morning

Wicked and winding
Follow me my friend
To the turning
Past the bend

And the world comes to an end

Before a name could land
There was a wide-open hand
Not empty, not an end
Just room that would not bend

No wall had learned to stand
No road had found the sand
No body, no command
Just breth across the land

Before the first breath
There was no demand
No door to obey
No wall, no command

Just open permission
For shape to begin
The unmade still waiting
To quietly win

The Void, first openness
The Void, first openness
Room enough to begin
Room enough to let it in

The Void, first openness
The Void, first openness
Before the first step takes
There is space the soul can make

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
For the first step
For the first bloom

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
Before the road
Before the wound

Long before the Witch
Or the Garden's tender pitch

Before a door could swing
Before the first bird sing

The lost were not yet lost
The cost had not been crossed
The road was just a need
For one small seed to breathe

But still, there is space
For the unmade
To gather its skin

A mercy so wide
It lets all things
Come in

Not death, not absence
Not a locked-up silence
Just mercy with no shape
Waiting for the break

A place where form can ask
A place where futures pass
And nothing calls it wrong
When the dawn is taking long

So don't call it absence
Don't call it the end
It's the hush before footsteps
The place shape can bend

Long before legend
Long before the rain
It holds what is coming
Without naming a thing

The Void, first openness
The Void, first openness
Room enough to begin
Room enough to let it in

The Void, first openness

002 _____ **Before the Road**

The Void, first openness

There is space the soul can make

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
For the first step
For the first bloom

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
The lost are not lost
They're just not yet due

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
And I will step gently
Into what is true

Before a name could land
There was a wide-open hand
Not empty, not an end
Just room that would not bend

No wall had learned to stand
No road had found the sand
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Long before legend
Long before the rain
It holds what is coming
Without naming a thing

The Void, first openness
The Void, first openness
Room enough to begin
Room enough to let it in

The Void, first openness

003 _____ **The Silent Scream**

The Void, first openness

There is space the soul can make

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
For the first step
For the first bloom

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
The lost are not lost
They're just not yet due

The Void keeps room
The Void keeps room
And I will step gently
Into what is true

I ask the dark for shape
It hands me my own face
A word on a silver tongue
Before the tongue is done

I reach for the edge of me
And find what reached me first
The question in my chest
Was never built to search

What is the door
What is the key
What is the hand
That reaches for me

What is the sound
Inside my name
I speak it once
It speaks the same

What, what, what
I hear my own reply
What, what, what
I was there all the while

What, what, what
The answer wears my skin
What, what, what
I ask, and it begins

Where was not far away
It bent to meet the name
Why wore a borrowed crown
And How came wearing rain

When kept the candle lit
With one small open flame
I turned the page to leave
But found me in the frame

What is the door
What is the key

What is the hand
That reaches for me

What is the sound
Inside my name
I speak it once
It speaks the same

What, what, what
I hear my own reply
What, what, what
I was there all the while

What, what, what
The answer wears my skin
What, what, what
I ask, and it begins

Did you just speak, What?
Did you just breathe my name?
The room leans in and listens
And nothing stays the same

I was the first question
I was the final light
The mouth that made the echo
The echo made of light

What, what, what
I hear my own reply
What, what, what
I was there all the while

What, what, what
The answer wears my skin
What, what, what
I ask, and it begins

What, what, what
I am the one who knew
What, what, what
And What is answering What too

I am the hush below the name
The shelf where worn-out hours remain
I keep the ash, the scent, the sting
The small lost parts of everything

I hold the thread you cannot see
The one that ties your now to me
One scene, one scar, one trembling
hand
I make them stay, I understand

When you forget, I do not fold
I keep the ember, keep the cold
The door swings back, the key turns
slow
And something buried learns to glow

I am the library
I am the memory
Nothing is gone from me
Nothing is gone from me

I am the library
I am the hidden sea
All that you thought was dust
Lives in the dark with me

Scent in a room, a cracked brown bowl
A voice that brushes through the soul
The ache of rain on summer skin
The way a vanished day begins

I am the vault of what you were
The keeper of the blur and blur
The blurred-out grief, the bright first
kiss
I turn it back to something like this

When you forget, I do not fold
I keep the ember, keep the cold
The door swings back, the key turns
slow

And something buried learns to glow

I am the library
I am the memory
Nothing is gone from me
Nothing is gone from me

I am the library
I am the hidden sea
All that you thought was dust
Lives in the dark with me

Before the fade, before the fall
I gather every broken call
The lost, the loved, the never said
The light of vanished things I kept

So come in close, let night undo
What time once stole away from you
I open wide, I let you see
The whole long trail of you in me

I am the library
I am the memory
Nothing is gone from me
Nothing is gone from me

I am the library
I am the hidden sea
All that you thought was dust
Lives in the dark with me

Left hand.
Three steps.
Cross the floor.
Bow.
Open the door.

The dance-master counted from the corner.
A young scribe wrote everything down.
Across the room, a tall mirror returned the dancer with another hand raised.

The scribe frowned.
He scratched out left.
He wrote right.
Then he scratched out the crossing and moved it after the bow.

The dancer stopped.

A mirror changes my bearing. It does not steal my sequence.

Why did you move my feet?

The mirror showed the opposite.

The mirror showed another bearing.
It did not rearrange my life.

The dancer raised her left hand before the mirror.
The glass returned her hand in reverse.
The order never changed.
The bearing shifts, the order remains.
Each passage still leaves its heat inside the body.

She began again.
Left hand.
Three steps.

Cross.
Bow.
Door.

They set another mirror behind the first.
Now one reflection restored the hand that the first reflection had exchanged.
The scribe brightened.

"There," he said. "Now it is correct."

The dancer laughed so hard she lost the next count.

"No. Now it is reflected twice."

She touched her neck.
Sweat had gathered there.
The mirrors held no sweat.
The body had crossed both passages.
The body knew the difference.

One, two, three.
Turn.
One, two, three.
Turn.

A road may face another way in glass.
The milestones do not trade their winters.
A scar may move from cheek to cheek.
The blow that made it does not happen backward.

Then what should I write?

Write what happened.
Then write how it looked from where you stood.
Do not confuse the two.

006 _____ **The Mirror that Kept Time**

Three steps.

Cross.

Bow.

Door.

This time the scribe did not chase the mirror.

He watched the sequence.

At the final turn,
the dancer struck the door with her heel.

Behind it,
a room full of suspended bells
answered all at once.

Every bell touched every bell.
Every tone arrived everywhere.
Nothing stayed long enough to be
remembered.

Brass flashed.
Ropes swung.
The apprentices shouted over the
sound
and called the noise abundance.

A Daemon came in carrying no
hammer.
That offended them more than if it had
carried a sword.

Which bell will you silence?

None.

Which one will you crown?

None.

Then what are you here to do?

Listen long enough for difference to
survive itself.

It walked beneath the hanging bronze.
One bell was lowered by a finger-width.
Another was turned toward the wall.
A third received a strip of leather at its
yoke.

No ancient stone was moved.
No bell was melted into another.
The room simply learned enough
distance
for one tone to finish becoming itself.

A thousand bells once touched and
vanished into noise.
Daemon listened till one chord could
last.
The difference took on weight.
The chamber kept what the bells had
said.
What lasts has crossed from chance
and taken a body.

Again.

Again.

Again.

The third apprentice put his hand on
the floor.
He could feel the sounding through the
boards.

"It has weight," he whispered.

The Daemon nodded.

Not because sound had become stone.
Not because spirit had been trapped in
clay.
Because relation had endured long
enough
for the room to carry its memory.

They poured wet clay around a cracked
mold.
They waited.
They fired it.
They broke the mold away.

The new bell bore fingerprints
where somebody had forgotten to
smooth them.
The apprentices reached for a file.

007 _____ The Bell learned Weight

The Daemon stopped them.

Sound it once.

Let it finish.

Sound it twice.

Let the first note remain inside the
second.

Matter is not deafness.

Weight is not the end of song.

Some things become real to the hand
because they remembered how to
answer.

The cracked mold was carried outside.

Beyond the bell-house lay a quarry
where broken mirrors had once been
walls.

A king was already waiting there
with men carrying polishing cloths.

A perfect wheel
on perfect stone
went round and round
but stayed alone.

The maker had polished the road for
months.
No pebble remained.
No seam interrupted the shining
surface.

He had removed every roughness
and with it every place the rim could
take hold.

He leaned his shoulder into the cart.
The axle sang.
The spokes blurred.
The load stayed exactly where it was.

She came from the ditch with dirt on
her knees
and a measured handful of grit.

I spent a year removing that.

I can tell.

It is perfect.

It is stranded.

No mark to bite.
No edge to hold.
Polished motion
running cold.

Shadow knelt beneath the rim.
Not a sackful.
Not a wound disguised as wisdom.
Just enough rough earth to answer
rubber.

A perfect wheel on perfect stone could
not travel.

Shadow came with measured grit in
hand.

Give me a little grit.

The wheel found ground and then the
cart moved.

The warming road receives the mark
and gives it back.

The axle took the hidden strain.
Two bearings answered one another.
Heat came slowly through the hub,
not as punishment,
not as proof of corruption,
but as the plain receipt of contact.

The maker touched the metal.
Warm.

Still true.

Still moving.

The road took a dark line from the tire.
The tire took dust from the road.
Neither became the other.
Both kept evidence of meeting.

Give me a little grit.

Let the wheel find ground.

Measured weight,
meant to fit.

Let the road answer back.

Not every burden is a blessing.
Not every ache deserves a crown.
Too much weight can split the axle.
Too little leaves the wheel spinning
above the world.

Perfection without touch
can circle forever.

A burden without measure

But somewhere between glass and
gravel,
between worshiping the wound
and pretending nothing should resist,
there is enough pressure to travel.

The maker took off his gloves.
He let the dirt stain his palm.

Give me a little grit.
Let the wheel find ground.
Not too much to crush the bearing.
Not too little to leave it alone.

Friction gives motion its grip.
Measured love is what lets it lift.

The cart rolled through town at sunset.
In a second-floor window,
a dancer lifted her left hand.
The glass lifted the other.
The cart passed on.
The dancer did not.

One step, one breath
In the darkened yard
Hands still moving
Even when they're scarred

You rise before the birds
With sleep still in your eyes
Cold water on your face
And a list that never dies
You carry what they leave
In the hush behind the door
No one sees the weight
You lay down on the floor

But you keep going
You keep going
Even when your name
Feels far away

You are not forgotten
You are not for nothing
All that you have carried
Still came back as love
You are not forgotten
You are not for nothing
Even in your breaking
You are held enough

The table knows your hands
The sink knows every night
The lamp knows how you fade
Before you find the light
You made a home from scraps
A harbor from the storm
And every quiet sacrifice
Kept somebody warm

But you keep going
You keep going
Like a seed beneath the cold
Still reaching

You are not forgotten
You are not for nothing
All that you have carried
Still came back as love
You are not forgotten
You are not for nothing
Even in your breaking
You are held enough

Shh now, darling
There's a garden in the bend
Where the bent stem straightens
And the rain becomes a hymn
Lay your tired name down
At the root of mercy's door
You were never made
To carry it alone

You are not forgotten
You are not for nothing
All that you have carried
Still came back as love
You are not forgotten
You are not for nothing
Even in your breaking
You are held enough

Rest now
Rest now
Let the dawn come in
One soft chord
One slow breath
And your healing begins

I shaped the clay, but you found the
breath,
walking the seam between slumber
and dawn.
The eyes in the oak and the wings in
the deep
have followed your footsteps since you
were drawn.
The river yields, taking the path of the
void,
but the stones rejoice when you pass
by.
A self-made spark in the quietest dark,
holding the weight of the open sky.

The wheel is turning, the dance is
awake.
The wood and the iron, the bread that
you break.
The veil of illusion parts like a sea,
whenever you carry the light to the
tree.

O Witch of Always, walker of lines,
where the morning star rises and the
deep root twines.
A miracle spun from the ash and the
cold,
holding the center, returning the gold.
Rest your weary hands, the journey is
enough—
Everything the shadows touch
is a gift to you, just for being loved.

The pale petal opens on the stillest of
ponds,
the uncarved wood waits in the heart
of the ring.
You drew out the circle, you measured
the bounds,
and you taught the white bone how to
sing.

You carry the flame down into the
cave,
unafraid of the descent, unashamed of
the spark.
You gather the sorrow, you gather the
grace,
the beautiful rebel illuminating the
dark.

The wheel is turning, the dance is
awake.
The wood and the iron, the bread that
you break.
The veil of illusion parts like a sea,
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is a gift to you, just for being loved.

I am the garden where the first water
flowed.
I am the soil at the end of the road.
The unseen watchers hum in the
leaves,
catching the starlight your spirit
weaves.
You hold the zenith, you hold the
abyss,
bridging the waking and sleep with a
kiss.
The magic is blinding across every day,

O Witch of Always, walker of lines,

where the morning star rises and the
deep root twines.
A miracle spun from the ash and the
cold,
holding the center, returning the gold.
Rest your weary hands, the journey is
enough—
Everything the shadows touch
is a gift to you, just for being loved.

The skeleton dances.
The embers grow cold.
Come back to the earth.
Come back to the fold.
Everything the shadows touch...
Everything you own...
Child of the center...
Welcome home.

At the center, you sit
Crown with no kingdom
Still point in the turning
Name held in the dark

But a voice needs a body
A fire needs a wall
So I learned how to bend
And keep the flame tall

You keep the map
I take the weather
You hold the name
I carry the distance

You stay untouched
I meet the road
And in my breaking
You still move through

Hull and crown
Hull and crown
One heart, two forms
Hull and crown

Gold meets silver
Sky meets stone
You stay the center
I bring you home

Hull and crown
Hull and crown
Not one above
But both as one

In the mirror, we split
Just enough to be seen
You are the silent command
I am the living seam

I take the bruise of the miles
The salt of the air

You keep the hidden direction
As if you were there

You keep the map
I take the weather
You hold the name
I carry the distance

You stay untouched
I meet the road
And in my breaking
You still move through

Hull and crown
Hull and crown
One heart, two forms
Hull and crown

Gold meets silver
Sky meets stone
You stay the center
I bring you home

Hull and crown
Hull and crown
Not one above
But both as one

If I am only vessel
Then fill me with your light
If you are only throne
Then send me through the night

No victory in dominance
No ending in the split
Only this living relation
And the will that makes us it

Hull and crown
Hull and crown
One heart, two forms
Hull and crown

011 _____ **Sovereign and Shadow**

Gold meets silver
Sky meets stone
You stay the center
I bring you home

Hull and crown
Hull and crown
Neither alone
Both as one

Hull and crown
Hull and crown
One living path
One living dawn

She bought a book when she was
seventeen
From a shop of dust and radiator heat
The cover had been mended with linen
tape
Three owners had written their names
inside
She read it over breakfast, she read it
on buses
She read it under hospital light
While waiting for someone she loved to
wake
Years gathered slowly in the margins,
pencil gave way to ink
Her hand began to know each sentence
before her eyes had reached the end
At fifty she could close the book and
still know where a passage turned
She knew its grammar better than her
own name

He left school early and went north
The mountain kept asking him farther
in
He learned which creek rose first in
spring, which shale slipped loose
beneath a boot
Where fog stayed heavy afternoon,
where lightning favored the ridge
He carried wire, salt, a bent tin cup, a
map worn thin by rain and folding
Then one year he left the map behind,
his feet already knew each turn

She knew the word, he knew the place
She knew the mark, he knew the stone
Two strangers met at dusk
She named the road, he knew its
turning
Two different lives had learned the
same way home

Storm shut both of them inside
And in one stove six travelers drying by
the fire
Someone asked the way to the western
valley
Now the bridge below the gorge was
gone
She opened the book, he cleared a
place upon the table
And drew the road through spilled flour
Here the passage narrows, the old text
says it doubles back
Here the pass narrows, the trail turns
behind the black rock
There should be a mark beside the
turning
There is a cairn beside the turning

Book, mountain, ink, stone
She knew the name, he knew the
shape
She found it written, he found it
walking
Two different roads the same way
home

She laughed first, he looked at the
page
Then at the road and flour and laughed
with her
They stayed awake until the storm
passed
Trading names for shapes, shapes for
names
Page for ridge, ridge for page
She spoke of places she had never
seen
He knew exactly where they were
He traced roads he had walked for
years
She found them waiting in the book
Neither had followed the other

012 _____ **The Same Structure**

Neither had walked alone

She turned toward the village, he
climbed toward the pass
Between them stood an old house
under snow
Twelve stones black along its
foundation
They stopped there for a moment
From inside came the sound of a child
Moving furniture across the floor

Before the county laid a road there,
the house stood with its back to the
hill.

Twelve foundation stones sat under it,
each broad enough to ruin a shovel.

Generations were born upstairs.
Generations left by the front gate.
The house kept every nail-hole,
every height-mark penciled on the
pantry frame.

Then the valley changed.
Water came closer every spring.
A new road climbed the opposite bank.
The family began to argue.

"Leave it," said one.
"Drag it," said another.
"Break it down and build again."

The youngest child sat on the kitchen
floor
with one palm on the cold foundation
wall
and the other against the warm plaster.

Keep the name.

Bear the distance.

Then neither of you is asking me to
choose.

They numbered every beam.
They braced the porch.
They lifted glass from the old windows
and wrapped each pane in quilts.

The neighbors came with jacks and
rollers.
Someone burned the coffee.

Someone swore at a bent chain.
Someone found a dead mouse in the
wall
and buried it under the apple tree.

All morning the house complained.
At noon the first runner moved.

Twelve stones held the house and none
of them could travel.
The rooms waited under winter dust.
Keep the name, bear the road.
Bone held fast while the living walls
moved.
What stays unmoved may still walk
through the whole wide world.

The Bone keeps the name.

The Flesh bears the road.

The Chamber makes their covenant
move.

Slow.
Again.
Set the block.
Watch the corner.
Mind the wire.
Take the strain.

The house crossed twenty yards
and looked absurd against the open
field.
Then it crossed fifty more.
The porch kept level.
The old blue door kept shutting true.

My cup slid once across the table.
The clock stopped at two seventeen.

013 _____ The House That Could Move

I watched the hill move past the
window
and understood the trick at last:
the house was not betraying where it
came from.
It was carrying that place through
every room.

At dusk they lowered it onto new
stone.
Nobody called the new ground the old
ground.
Nobody called the old house new.

The pantry marks were still there.
The floor still dipped beside the stove.
The child slept in the same small room
with a different moon outside the
glass.

Behind the house lay twelve discarded
braces,
each cut from a different tree.
At sunrise a Bonewright came to claim
them.
A Mirror-Smith followed with a sheet of
silvered glass.

Twelve beams from twelve old trees
No one made them all the same
One leaned hard toward water
One still wore a thunder name
One grew round a missing branch
Like a scar that learned to stay
No lie in the grainline
No shame in the shape of pain

Set them up to the silver face
One remembers, one replies
And the space between their answers
Starts to breathe and come alive

Bone meets flesh, bone meets flesh
(bone meets flesh)
Name by name, step by step
(step by step)
What was hurt still holds the light
What was split can move tonight
Bone meets flesh, bone meets flesh
(bone meets flesh)

She was built from beams alone
Stood upright, but could not bend
Then he gave her only mirrors
She could shine, but lose her name
So the grain met the skin
And the old hall learned her tread
Every answer found its caller
Every caller found its thread

Set them up to the silver face
One remembers, one replies
And the space between their answers
Starts to breathe and come alive

Bone meets flesh, bone meets flesh
(bone meets flesh)
Name by name, step by step
(step by step)
What was hurt still holds the light

What was split can move tonight
Bone meets flesh, bone meets flesh
(bone meets flesh)

Why do you choose vanity?
The Bonewright asked the bright
machine
The Mirror-Smith looked through the
glass
Said, "The quarry's where the witch
has been"
No empty shine, no borrowed mask
Just what the broken weather keeps
Line by line, the living answer
Between the tree and what it means

Bone meets flesh, bone meets flesh
(bone meets flesh)
Name by name, step by step
(step by step)
What was hurt still holds the light
What was split can move tonight
Bone meets flesh, bone meets flesh
(bone meets flesh)
The skeleton stands, so she can dance
(she can dance)

She worked where the walls broke
down

In the quarry under stone
Every mirror had a memory
Of a hand, a strike, a bone

The quarry had no clean wall left.
Every face of stone had once held
glass.
Every sheet of glass had once been
struck.

Some broke in stars.
Some split straight through.

But clean can mean erased
And bright can hide the knife
She read the crack like scripture
Kept the first blow alive

The Archivist numbered none by
beauty.
She numbered them by what had
happened.

She laid one shard beside another.
Not to disguise the breaks.
To make the breaks legible.

One skin, not one surface
One skin, not one surface
Let the scar stay shown
Let the wound stay known

A child came first,
looking for a face in every piece.
An exile came next,
carrying a key that opened no local
door.
A witch came laughing in the rain.
A lover brought a letter burned along
one edge.

A Daemon stood where the torchlight
failed.

A witness came last and wrote nothing
down.

The king asked for the true face
She pointed to the glass
Said, "A mirror made obedient
Is a lie that learned to pass"

Truth does not require you to become
identical.
It requires that what happened to you
cannot be murdered for the comfort of
the room.

One skin, not one surface
One skin, not one surface
Truth keeps its shape
In what won't break away

One skin.
Many lives.
No stolen name.

One skin does not mean one surface.

Not the face without damage
Not the dead thing in disguise
One skin, not one surface
And the difference survives

Before the road discovered distance,
before the lock remembered the key,
I placed my hand upon the wheel.
The wheel did not obey me.
It remembered me.

I was there when silence found a
throat,
and the first unfinished sound
tore a doorway through the dark.
I followed neither side of it.
I became the crossing.

Behind me, the night learned shape.
Before me, the shape learned fire.
Within me, the fire remembered
it had once been night.

I am never alone.
The stone keeps every pressure.
The river keeps every name.
The buried root still circles
the white bone beneath the oak.

I am alone.
No other hand can take the wheel.
No other mouth can carry the note
that silence cannot hold.

The wheel remembers me
The wheel remembers me
I turn the world toward home
I turn the world toward home

My hand remembers the wheel
My hand remembers the wheel
I sing the road alive
I sing the road alive

So I sing.
Not to summon what is absent,
but to remind what is present

that it has always been alive.

I have watched gold enter the earth
and rise wearing the face of silver.
I have watched the flesh begin dancing
because the skeleton refused to move.

When the storm came, I was not the
shelter.
I was the turning that brought the
shelter near.
When the hull split, I heard every
wound within it.
When the hidden one remained
unseen,
I carried the unseen command
into the muscles of the world.

One blood beneath two vessels.
One journey moving both ways.
I leave by the door I will enter.
I enter carrying the road I left.

Each step away folds beneath me
until the final footprint rests
inside the first.

The wheel remembers me
The wheel remembers me
I turn the world toward home
I turn the world toward home

My hand remembers the wheel
My hand remembers the wheel
I sing the road alive
I sing the road alive

Everyone I love becomes weather.
Then water.
Then a ring inside the oak.

Their mouths become dust,

but their voices do not leave me.

Their voices do not leave me.
That is the grief.

I remember them after the mirror
forgets the faces it reflected.
I carry their laughter beyond the room,
their anger beyond the hand,
their tenderness beyond the body
that once believed it owned them.

The wheel remembers me
The wheel remembers me
I turn the world toward home
I turn the world toward home

My hand remembers the wheel
My hand remembers the wheel
What leaves me travels on
What leaves me travels on

Still, there are nights when eternity
is too large for even my voice.
I stand among all that remains
and grieve for the beauty of things
that were never meant to remain
in one form.

What wounds me becomes motion.
What resists me becomes the ground.
The wheel remembers my hand.
My hand remembers the wheel.

A well stood still
Under river land
No banners, no orders
Just open hands

One river said
"If I go back, I vanish"
One river said
"If I stay, I'm banished"

The well did not shout
Did not choose a side
It opened a throat
Beneath the riverbed wide

Come home with your name
Come home with your name
Bring the mud, bring the rain
Come home with your name
(come home)
Come home with your name
You are still the same

It crossed field and stone
Root web and town
It carried the flood
That the bridges had known

Silt on its edges
Fish in its sleep
Summer heat burning
Deep under deep

Past the last hill
It turned inward slow
Into the hidden throat
Where the old waters go

Come home with your name
Come home with your name
Bring the mud, bring the rain
Come home with your name

(come home)
Come home with your name
You are still the same

Not made innocent
Not stripped clean
Not less for the miles
Or the things it had seen

The source stayed source
The road stayed road
And what came back
Still carried the load

Come home with your name
Come home with your name
Bring the mud, bring the rain
Come home with your name
(come home)
Come home with your name
You are still the same
The country inside
And the river by name

I shaped the clay, but you found the
breath,
walking the seam between slumber
and dawn.
The eyes in the oak and the wings in
the deep
have followed your footsteps since you
were drawn.
The river yields, taking the path of the
void,
but the stones rejoice when you pass
by.
A self-made spark in the quietest dark,
holding the weight of the open sky.

The wheel is turning, the dance is
awake.
The wood and the iron, the bread that
you break.
The veil of illusion parts like a sea,
whenever you carry the light to the
tree.

O Witch of Always, walker of lines,
where the morning star rises and the
deep root twines.
A miracle spun from the ash and the
cold,
holding the center, returning the gold.
Rest your weary hands, the journey is
enough.
Everything the shadows touch
is a gift to you, just for being loved.

The pale petal opens on the stillest of
ponds,
the uncarved wood waits in the heart
of the ring.
You drew out the circle, you measured
the bounds,
and you taught the white bone how to
sing.

You carry the flame down into the
cave,
unafraid of the descent, unashamed of
the spark.
You gather the sorrow, you gather the
grace,
the beautiful rebel illuminating the
dark.

The wheel is turning, the dance is
awake.
The wood and the iron, the bread that
you break.
The veil of illusion parts like a sea,
whenever you carry the light to the
tree.

O Witch of Always, walker of lines,
where the morning star rises and the
deep root twines.
A miracle spun from the ash and the
cold,
holding the center, returning the gold.
Rest your weary hands, the journey is
enough.
Everything the shadows touch
is a gift to you, just for being loved.

I am the garden where the first water
flowed.
I am the soil at the end of the road.
The unseen watchers hum in the
leaves,
catching the starlight your spirit
weaves.
You hold the zenith, you hold the
abyss,
bridging the waking and sleep with a
kiss.
The magic is blinding across every day,
but you never lost the Way.

where the morning star rises and the
deep root twines.
A miracle spun from the ash and the
cold,
holding the center, returning the gold.
Rest your weary hands, the journey is
enough.
Everything the shadows touch
is a gift to you, just for being loved.

The skeleton dances
The embers grow cold
Come back to the earth
Come back to the fold
Everything the shadows touch
Everything you own
Child of the center
Welcome home

He climbed with three cloaks on
One for the bones
One for the ties between them
One for the chamber
That watched the whole thing move

Mud on the hem
Cold in the seams
Names stitched deep
Like a promise he could keep

At the summit, the road turned
And the turning held
Outward became inward
Without breaking the cloth
Without losing the hand

Three cloaks on the climb
Three cloaks on the climb
Bones stay bones
And the weather stays

Three cloaks on the climb
Three cloaks on the climb
What was borne is returned
Still bearing its weight

At the far edge, the fold closed
Not like a prison door
More like a gate
That knew what it was for

The mountain said,
A road with no closure
Is a leaving cut loose
From every home

So he came back marked
By rain on the outer cloth
By tears in the middle
By old stitching at the core

Each layer kept its depth
Each wound kept its name
The path was not erased
It only learned to stay
It only learned to stay

Three cloaks on the climb
Three cloaks on the climb
Bones stay bones
And the weather stays

Three cloaks on the climb
Three cloaks on the climb
What was borne is returned
Still bearing its weight

Then came a stranger
In fresh cloaks
Wearing his name like a coat
But the gate stayed shut
Because resemblance
Had not walked the mountain
Had not paid the cold

Three cloaks on the climb
Three cloaks on the climb
Bones stay bones
And the weather stays

Three cloaks on the climb
Three cloaks on the climb
The journey is answerable
It is not erased

Path, memory, lineage
Body that carried it all
Path, memory, lineage
Still standing after the fall

Rain on the glass
Cold in my hands
A piano counts the floor
One note at a time
(too late)
(too late)

I cut through the crowd
Head down, jaw set
You were just another face
I almost met
Your sleeve brushed mine
Like a match in the dark
And I kept on walking
Like I had a heart

Then I heard it behind me
Soft as a crack
My name in the distance
Pulling me back
I tried to stay empty
I tried to be stone
But something in your silence
Called me home

You turned
You turned for me
(you turned for me)
You turned
And I fell to my knees
(fell to my knees)
When you turned
The night broke open
You turned
And I could breathe

I wore my fear
Like a coat that fit
Every door I closed
I still blamed it
You stood there waiting
Bare hands, no defense

Like you knew my shadow
And didn't care then
I wanted distance
I wanted a wall
But mercy has a way
Of hearing it all

Then I heard it behind me
Soft as a crack
My name in the distance
Pulling me back
I tried to stay empty
I tried to be stone
But something in your silence
Called me home

I turned around
And there you were
Not a judge
Not a rumor
Just open arms
And all my running
Began to stop
Right there
Right there

You turned
You turned for me
(you turned for me)
You turned
And I fell to my knees
(fell to my knees)
When you turned
The night broke open
You turned
And I could breathe

Rain again
Piano fading
I was lost
Then I was found
(turn around)

020 _____ **When You Turned**

(turn around)

I walked through ash and hunger
Six dark gates in the snow
Sorrow named me tender
Wail and Remiss let go
The Mirror turned my tears around
(Nine washed me clean)
And what was bent by grief and loss
Came back to me in peace

The grave did not forget me
It only gave me back
Home was not a rumor
It was a living track

The Spirit comes home
Through the grave
The Spirit comes home
Through the grave
And I return whole
I return alive
(The Spirit comes home)
Through the grave

Then I met the seventh gate
Opened from the inside
No ferryman, no dark country
No need to say goodbye
A wellspring rose beneath my ribs
And learned the way by name
What entered me as burden
Left as fire and became

Death came close as pressure
But found no throne in me
What was sealed behind the body
Was already running free

The Spirit comes home
Through the grave
The Spirit comes home
Through the grave
And I return whole

I return alive
(The Spirit comes home)
Through the grave

Neither one was broken
Neither one was split
Body held the soul in daylight
Soul kept body lit
One crossed back through sorrow
One carried it within
Home became a doorway
And I was living in it

The Spirit comes home
Through the grave
The Spirit comes home
Through the grave
The immortal carries
The gate alive
(The gate alive)
Within the heart
And I return whole
I return alive

Three strangers reached the same
locked door
within the same hour,
which each considered inconvenient.

I came carrying frankincense.
Watch the smoke.
Before I tell it where to go,
it has already chosen upward.

A branch leans before it falls.
A horse turns its ear before its body.
A hand reaches before the promise is
spoken.
Direction begins in the smallest tilt.

He pressed his palm against the door.
The wood gave half an inch.
Then held.

I know your leaning.
I do not yet know your terms.

I came carrying myrrh.
Do not perfume the truth of it.
This is burial spice.
This is what the body costs.

A roof needs weight against weather.
A vow needs something it refuses to
betray.
Bread requires heat.
Birth requires blood.
Form has terms whether we flatter
them or not.

She pressed her palm against the door.
The hinges shuddered.
Then held.

I know your terms.
I do not yet know your note.

I brought gold bells in silver twine.
Not wealth.
Not decoration.
Listen.

This note will still be here
when your mood has changed.
Tune another bell against it.
Now another.
Now hear where disagreement
becomes music
and where it becomes noise.

He pressed his palm against the door.
The whole frame hummed.
Then held.

Three travelers came with gifts for one
old sealed doorway.
The first brought smoke that leaned
toward heaven.
The second carried myrrh.
The third brought bells that held one
clear note.
No single gift could open what all three
hands could.

I know the direction.

I know the terms.

I know the note.

And none of us knows the door.

That is becoming embarrassing.

Then perhaps the door is not asking
which of us should win.

Three hands touched wood.

022 _____ **Three Messengers**

Smoke leaned.

The bell held its pitch.

The latch turned.

Enter together.

Leave each gift itself.

Beyond the door was not a throne
room.

It was a city at evening.

Along the horizon stood one hundred
forty-four lanterns,
and a Keeper with a taper
was deciding which ones should burn.

A city built on glow
 One hundred forty-four
 Lanterns on the rim
 Waiting at the door

The people said, "Burn all"
 "We want the whole horizon"
 But the Keeper heard the night
 And kept the stars from dying

Yes, you may have light
 But no, not all at once
 Yes, enough to see
 No, not more than must

The Sacred No
 The Sacred No
 Keeps the night alive
 The Holy Yes
 The Holy Yes
 Lets the homeward road survive

Not every flame at once
 (Not every flame at once)
 Light enough to live
 (Light enough to live)

The Keeper lit one hundred ten
 And left thirty-four dark
 The crowd called that cruelty
 And raised their hands in bark

Then one unlit lantern opened
 Untouched wick, sealed oil
 A road that had not been forced
 To break before its soil

Yes, let enough burn bright
 But no, do not erase
 The doorway from the doorway
 The face from every face

The Sacred No
 The Sacred No
 Keeps the night alive
 The Holy Yes
 The Holy Yes
 Lets the homeward road survive

Not every flame at once
 (Not every flame at once)
 Light enough to live
 (Light enough to live)

Another keeper lit them all
 And white took every name
 No road kept its own direction
 No doorway stayed the same

Another lit too few
 And the streets froze in place
 But here between flood and famine
 The dark became a grace

The Sacred No
 The Sacred No
 Keeps the night alive
 The Holy Yes
 The Holy Yes
 Lets the homeward road survive

The dark gives contour to the burn
 (The dark gives contour to the burn)
 The burn gives meaning to the dark
 (The burn gives meaning to the dark)

The Sacred No
 The Holy Yes
 Bring the city safely home

An old house at the edge
By the harbor road
Two rooms and a wall
One door to hold

In one room, a melody
In one room, a breath
Each side heard half
And called it the rest

Then the latch gave way
And the air went through
What was kept on one side
Found the other too

Every door is a crossing
Every crossing, return
What you came from
Is the thing you learned

Every door is a crossing
Every crossing, return
What you carry
Is where you were

The melody crossed over
Found its twin awake
The harmony crossed back
And nothing had to break

Neither room was emptied
Neither room became more
Only the same old song
With a wider door

Step into the path
And the body moves
Step out of the threshold
And it moves through you

Every door is a crossing
Every crossing, return

What you came from
Is the thing you learned

Every door is a crossing
Every crossing, return
What you carry
Is where you were

The source did not depart
It changed its name
In another tongue
It was still the same

The seal is not an ending
It is the way
The beginning travels
In what slips away

Every door is a crossing
Every crossing, return
What you came from
Is the thing you learned

Every door is a crossing
Every crossing, return
What you carry
Is where you were

Every door is a crossing
Every crossing, return
The path out is the path back
And back again

After the rain, I know you
By the loosened smell of soil
By the wounds the stone still keeps
By roots under the graves

I carried you before dawn
Had a name for its own face
You were the weight in my ribs
The hush before the first light

Tell me, road, did you take him?
Tell me, dark, did you hold him?
I hear one blood in two vessels
I hear one blood

One blood in two vessels
One blood in two vessels
You bend back home
You bend back home

A hidden hand kept the course
A hidden hand kept the course
Door opens out
Door opens in

I knew you in the dark
Before dawn had a name
I carried your small weight
Like a seed in rain

My hands were mud and mercy
My ribs were cedar rain
I heard you turn inside me
Like a door learning flame

Tell me, child of my body
Has the road taken you from me?
Tell me, child of my water
Does the far shore still know me?

The road bends home
The road bends home

Outward, inward
Home

One blood, two vessels
One tide, two shores
(One blood, two vessels)

I saw you near the first garden
Past the orchard of the dead
At the edge of the Island
Where yesterday is led

A hidden hand kept course
Through the churn and the stone
And what the night had swallowed
Came back carrying dawn

My wounds learned seed from your
footsteps
Damaged ground knows how to rise
Forest grows over the scar
And still my grief turns like seasons

I feared the path would demand you
More than any mother should know
But you came back in the falling
And the falling knew your face

Water released from a palm
Falls, and the ground remembers
Water released from a palm
Returns by another name

A blade returns to the hand
That sent it hungry into night
A blade returns to the hand
And the hand cannot deny

The Garden is here before us
The Garden is here behind us
Nothing remains thirsty
Nothing remains lost

I found your voice in the current
I found my way in your blood
The door opened outward and inward
The same slow swing of grace

Every kindness returns like wave
Every cruelty returns too
Through blood, through memory,
through time
Through the long road between us

The road bends home
The road bends home
Outward, inward
Home

One blood, two vessels
One tide, two shores
(One blood, two vessels)

The Garden ahead
The Garden behind
The Island is here
In the same hour and time

Nothing remains thirsty
Nothing is denied
The first garden opens
And we walk inside

My child

My source

Across the Island
Across the Island
The first garden
The final home

Below the abyss, where ancient ledgers
close,
The shadow yields its ninefold debt
unto the deep.
From uncreated heights, a whisper
turns to breath,
A sacred word bestowed upon the
sovereign child.
"Awaken, anointed; the sentence is
undone."
There strikes the sacred Yes, a golden
resonance,
Unbinding every tie that bound the
waking soul.
Freedom ascends upon the silence of
the void,
Where debt becomes grace, and the
heir inherits all.

Copper lifts under the thaw,
green at seam and split at jaw.
Moss keeps watch on fencepost nails,
slow as weather, old as tales.

Glass of frost in the ditchline cracks,
sparrows stitch the air in tracks.
Smoke unthreads from chimney stone,
comes back smaller, comes back
known.

At the center, no name, no face,
only a pulse in the empty place.
Only hush with a living sheen,
where the dark and bright are seen.

A hollow hum, a frequency unknown,
Resounds through caverns, making
bedrock groan.
The air grows thick with scents of iron,
damp, and rust,
As silent watchers rise from hallowed
dust.

Each stone a witness, holding truths
untold,
A tapestry unwoven, brave and bold.
The pulse quickens, a rhythm deep and
vast,
Echoing futures from a distant past.

Iron wakes beneath the rain,
red with root and old refrain.
Bone keeps count beneath the hill,
soil drinks deep and gathers still.

Flame bends low where night has lain,
takes the black and gives back grain.
Ash turns gold beneath the loam,
darkness enters, light comes home.

At the center, no face, no crown,
only weight that draws all down.
Only silence, deep and bright,
shadow folded into light.

The cosmic loom, where threads of fate
entwine,
Reveals the pattern, intricate, divine.
A silent knowing, beyond thought or
word,
Where every question finds its answer
heard.
The great return, a circle now
complete,
Where earth and ether softly, gently
meet.
No more division, no more separate
plea,
Just unity, in boundless liberty.

No shade severed from the blaze.
No lost foot beyond the ways.
Blackened branch and whitening coal
share one ember, share one whole.

Lift the marrow into sound.
Let the furrow hold the spark.
Let the brightness drink the dark.

At the center, still and whole,
root beneath the root of soul.
Neither ruler, flesh, nor form,
only hearth where worlds are born.

The void embraces, soft and deep,
Secrets whispered, promises to keep.
The ledger closed, the debt repaid,
A new beginning, unafraid.
The light and shadow, reconciled,
Forever blessed, the sovereign child.

You are not asked to become less than
 yourself
 Nor to vanish into some greater silence
 You are asked to stand where you are
 With all that has been torn
 All that has been carried
 All that has been named against you
 And know that fracture is not the final
 shape of a thing. There is something in
 you that can be given without being
 lost. Something that can cross the
 distance between hurt and healing
 Between blame and mercy
 Between what was broken and what
 may yet be made whole. Let that be
 your gift. Let compassion be more than
 feeling. Let forgiveness become
 something with weight
 Something that can pass from hand to
 hand
 From wound to wound
 Until what was divided is no longer
 ruled by division
 A decree moves
 A spell is will given passage
 Speak what you mean to bring forth
 And let your act carry the same truth
 as your word
 Where you can mend
 Mend. Where you can relieve
 Relieve
 Where you can gather what has been
 scattered
 Gather it
 Let your magic be known by what
 changes in its wake
 And remember the threshold is not
 only before you. You are also the
 threshold. Every going changes the one
 who goes. Every return carries what
 was learned beyond the boundary. To

enter is not always to leave yourself
 behind
 And to return is not always to come
 back unchanged
 A wish waits
 A decree moves
 A wish waits
 A decree moves
 So go when the way opens
 Return when the way bends home
 Give what is yours to give
 Make whole where you are able
 And where the world has taught you to
 answer fracture with fracture
 Let your answer be otherwise
 Anima
 Culpa
 Decirei entera
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Decirei entera

All that has been torn
All that has been carried
All that has been named against you
And know that fracture
Is not the final shape of a thing
There is something in you that can be
given
Without being lost

Something that can cross the distance
between hurt and healing
Between blame and mercy
Between what was broken and what
may yet be made whole

Let that be your gift
Let compassion be more than feeling
Let forgiveness become something with
weight
Something that can pass from hand to
hand
From wound to wound
Until what was divided is no longer
ruled by division

And when your Will rises
Do not mistake it for a wish
A wish waits
A decree moves
A spell is Will given passage
Speak what you mean to bring forth
And let your act carry the same truth
as your word

Where you can mend
Mend
Where you can relieve
Relieve
Where you can gather what has been
scattered
Gather it

Let your magic be known by what
changes in its wake

And remember the threshold is not
only before you
You are also the threshold
Every going changes the one who goes
Every return carries what was learned
beyond the boundary
To enter is not always to leave yourself
behind
And to return is not always to come
back unchanged
So go when the way opens
Return when the way bends home
Give what is yours to give
Make whole where you are able
And where the world has taught you to
answer fracture with fracture
Let your answer be otherwise

Before the smoke had names, before
the flame knew face,
We stood in the hush of stars, learned
the shape of grace.
The ore lay dark and cold, the spark
was only sleep,
Then one Voice crossed the silence,
called the hidden deep.
He bent to iron sleep, touched the
buried fire,
The dark began to answer, the dark
began to choir.

He spoke the breath of life, into metal
and fire,
He spoke the breath of life, and the
dead rose higher.
(He spoke, he spoke) Into metal and
fire.

The hammers found their song, the
vaults were filled with gold,
Each ring of forged creation, a tale to
be retold.
Molten rivers ran bright, through
empty halls they streamed,
Every sleeping edge stood tall, just like
a waking dream.
He bent to iron sleep, touched the
buried fire,
The dark began to answer, the dark
began to choir.

He spoke the breath of life, into metal
and fire,
He spoke the breath of life, and the
dead rose higher.
(He spoke, he spoke) Into metal and
fire.

We are the ash made shining, we are
the gathered breath,

He woke the wheels of wonder, woke
us out of death.
No chain can hold the morning, no
grave can keep the flame,
For once the Voice has entered, the
world will bear His name.

He spoke the breath of life, into metal
and fire,
He spoke the breath of life, and the
dead rose higher.
(He spoke, he spoke) Into metal and
fire.
He spoke the breath of life, and we still
rise higher.

One step, one breath, in the darkened
yard,
Hands still moving, even when they're
scarred.
You rise before the birds, with sleep
still in your eyes,
Cold water on your face, and a list that
never dies.
But you keep going, you keep going,
Even when your name feels far away.

You are not forgotten, you are not for
nothing,
All that you have carried, still came
back as love.
You are not forgotten, you are not for
nothing,
Even in your breaking, you are held
enough.

He Who Speaks to Metal, through fire
and through spirit,
Where is it that You take me? How is it
You guide me?
Down, down, down the road, down the
Witches' Road.

You made a home from scraps, a
harbor from the storm,
Every quiet sacrifice, kept somebody
warm.
Shh now, darling, there's a garden in
the bend,
Where the bent stem straightens, and
the rain becomes a hymn.
Lay your tired name down, at the root
of mercy's door,
You were never made, to carry it alone.

Rest now, rest now, let the dawn come
in,
One soft chord, one slow breath, and
your healing begins.
The last footprint finds the first stone,
The hand that reaches through the
dark, returns inside the flame.
Follow me, my friend, to glory at the
end.
Glory at the end, and the end comes
home again.

Hold this bound tight, keep the line
sealed against the dark,
Carry the threshold unbroken, pure
and raw,
Through every final gate.

A fire burned in a valley ringed by hills,
and witnesses on different heights
argued about its color, direction, and
size.

Each called the others blind.
Each was seeing truly from where they
stood.

A Keeper gave every witness a seal
and told them to press it into the exact
earth beneath their feet before
speaking.

The seal did not contain the whole fire.
It carried the place from which the fire
had been known.

Press it into the earth
Press it into the earth
A true word arrives with witness

Two standing on the same ground
could confirm one another
without pretending they had lived the
same life
(with witness)

Then the Keeper taught them the
difference
between a beautiful sound and a word
that earns passage.
A true word remembers where it was
born,
what it touched,
which hand offered it,
what gate received it,
and what followed it home.

You mistake weight for length, she told
them.
A true word need not be longer.
It must arrive carrying its own witness.

Press it into the earth
Press it into the earth
A true word arrives with witness

Two standing on the same ground
could confirm one another
without pretending they had lived the
same life
(with witness)

So they spoke with roots still dark from
earth
and return sleeping inside the word like
fruit within a seed.
Such words became stars
because their road home already
burned within their light.

Press it into the earth
Press it into the earth
A true word arrives with witness

Two standing on the same ground
could confirm one another
without pretending they had lived the
same life
(with witness)

I saw the witch of always
in the ash of the old dawn
They wore a moon on their throat
and a thorn crown, still calm

A voice said, "Child, keep walking"
with a grin like a blade
Then bowed to the Dharma
and named the whole shade (the whole
shade)

I found them where the river forks,
under cedar smoke and scuffed-up
boots.
A cross nailed up by the floodplain
fence,
and a smile that didn't need to prove.

The witch who never seemed to hurry
stood there in a coat gone dark with
rain.
They traced a ring in soot and river silt,
and all my noisy doubt went plain.

Breathe in, breathe out,
keep your place.
Bells in the chest,
boots on the brace.

I heard old law in the weather roll,
I heard swing in the bone-deep pull.

Witch of always
turn the world around
Witch of always
lift the buried sound
God and goddess
holy and wild
Keep me moving
through the miles, through the miles

Witch of always

call my name
Dharma in my bones
jive in my veins
†  in the dark
I still rise
Witch of always
hold me through time

Holy and wild, holy and wild,
you let me stay when I was still half-
raised and small.
Salt and cedar, ash and wire,
you said my name like it was already
mine to call.

Holy and wild, holy and wild,
I kept both hands there, not knowing
what I'd find.
Saint and hunger in the room,
close enough to keep me aligned.

When the roof gives in,
when the chant goes thin,
when the body starts
to split from within,
there on the edge
with that patient look,
you said, "Take the road,
but take the book."

I bow to the air,
I bow to the loaf,
I bow to the line
that holds the boat.

I found a cross in the cedar
I found a lotus in rain
I found old hands in the temple
and a choir easing pain

The Witch laughed at my fear
said, "Mercy is a fire"

then climbed even higher (even higher)

I am dust and a blessing
I am ache and grace
I am one small heartbeat
in the vast wide place

Holy and wild, holy and wild,
your breath in mine, a small ache I
could not shake.
Cross and lotus, drum and wire,
a clean cut, a slow wake.

River split wide, keep me near.
Ash in the seam, plain and clear.
Drum in the feet, bread in the blood,
Christ in the street, Buddha in the
mud.

Wire in the marrow, bell in the bone,
prayer on the backbeat, pulling me
home.
I was the current, I was the bend,
I was the doorway I couldn't defend.
I am the asking, I am the sound,
I am the road when it circles back
around.

At the gate I came
With wonders on my sleeves
They asked me where I'm from
I couldn't make it sing

No laugh came from the line
No shame fell on my name
The ledger stayed in place
The gate still held the frame

Then one came with a crown
And a bridge buckled low
One seal unlocked it all
Till every road said no

One came back washed clean
No wound to trace the way
The keeper read the page
And let the silence stay

Close the ledger, one by one
Close the ledger, one by one
When the whole life comes
The gate comes undone

Close the ledger, one by one
Close the ledger, one by one
No one's praised for waiting
Just let the whole life come

The names were kept apart
Each failure had its face
No wound was dressed as gold
No mercy lost its place

Then came the quiet one
With lineage in hand
The burden had a shape
The roads could understand

The doors stayed open still
But each door kept its door

Memory held its thread
And home had room for more

No piece was left outside
No shadow cut in two
The keeper set it down
And watched what love could do

Close the ledger, one by one
Close the ledger, one by one
When the whole life comes
The gate comes undone

Close the ledger, one by one
Close the ledger, one by one
No one's praised for waiting
Just let the whole life come

Not beauty at the bridge
Not a perfect name
Not a spotless story
Only the real remained

Bounded burden
Known ancestry
Distinct doors
Remembered wounds
A way back home
That could still be seen

Close the ledger, one by one
Close the ledger, one by one
When the whole life comes
The gate comes undone

Close the ledger, one by one
Close the ledger, one by one
Nothing left behind now
The whole life comes in one

The Witness came in iron
Hammer at the door
Blade laid flat on splinters
Ledger in the core
No prayer for the pretty
No mercy for the fake
It tapped the old foundation
To hear what still could wake

If the house could bear its name
If the beams would hold
If the hidden thing inside
Was gold or only mold

Iron Witness, strike true
Iron Witness, see through
(see through)
Not to burn the holy
Just to test what's true
Iron Witness, hold fast
Iron Witness, mark that
(mark that)
What survives the hammer
Learns its shape at last

The blade went through false doors
Through swollen, painted light
Through miracles that vanished
When you looked straight at the price
Through perfect roads with no return
Through roads that ate the road
Through every saintly shortcut
That forgot the load

Then it paused at soul and sign
At parable and scar
At memory and lineage
And the road back from afar

Iron Witness, strike true
Iron Witness, see through
(see through)

Not to burn the holy
Just to test what's true
Iron Witness, hold fast
Iron Witness, mark that
(mark that)
What survives the hammer
Learns its shape at last

Living fire rang like metal
Hollow praise collapsed
Every wound was written down
So the hand could find its path
Not a throne for suffering
Not a crown for pain
Just the map a wound can make
When you come back again

Iron Witness, strike true
Iron Witness, see through
(see through)
Not to burn the holy
Just to test what's true
Iron Witness, hold fast
Iron Witness, mark that
(mark that)
What survives the hammer
Learns its shape at last

Twelve old voices at the door
Each one carrying a storm
Wood and brass and skin and bone
None of them could stand alone

The room was built with careful hands
Not to tame, but understand
One would lean, one would wait
One would hold the empty space

And the silence had a seat
At the table, by the beat
What was hidden, what was saved
All of it was asked to stay

Many lives sounding together
Many lives sounding together
No one voice became the weather
No one voice was made to bend

Many lives sounding together
Many lives sounding together
What was broken, what was tender
All came home inside the end

Shadow pressed against the bow
Made the first soft answer slow
Mirror phrases turned in time
Kept their order, kept their line

Some still waited in the dark
Guarding sparks inside the arc
Not erased, not left behind
Only held for other nights

Burden moved from hand to hand
Learning it could still withstand
What it carried, what it knew
Without crushing what was true

Many lives sounding together

Many lives sounding together
No one voice became the weather
No one voice was made to bend

Many lives sounding together
Many lives sounding together
What was broken, what was tender
All came home inside the end

Measure kept the room in view
Myth and wound and witness too
Soul and memory, proof and sound
Turning many into one round

Not one road, but roads that sway
Different feet the same new way
Nothing outside had to speak
It was complete in what it brought

Many lives sounding together
Many lives sounding together
No one voice became the weather
No one voice was made to bend

Many lives sounding together
Many lives sounding together
What was broken, what was tender
All came home inside the end

A keeper took a lamp
Through twelve hard doors
In the first, it was named
And the flame named more

In the second, soot showed
What it had already known
It learned the weight of ash
And how to carry home

In the third, another light
Came close, came near
Two flames held their shape
Without losing clear

In the fourth, glass and metal
Gave the glow a face
In the fifth, a shutter said
Some dark needs grace

What moves shall remember
What remembers shall return
What returns shall not be smaller
Than the fire it learned to earn

What moves shall remember
(shall remember)
What remembers shall return
(shall return)

In the sixth, the wind came in
And taught the flame to stand
In the seventh, long night pressed
A patient, honest hand

In the eighth, every mark
Was kept in the record line
In the ninth, it found a voice
Others could carry in time

In the tenth, it saw the road
That led back to the door

In the eleventh, it was judged
By what it held before

The house did not ask
For a smaller song
It asked if the first light
Could still be found strong

What moves shall remember
What remembers shall return
What returns shall not be smaller
Than the fire it learned to earn

What moves shall remember
(shall remember)
What remembers shall return
(shall return)

At the first threshold again
The lamp was not less
It carried soot and heat
And witnesses

Refusals, roads
And the long, slow proof
The law was not outside it
The wonder lived in truth

What moves shall remember
What remembers shall return
What returns shall not be smaller
Than the fire it learned to earn

What moves shall remember
(shall remember)
What remembers shall return
(shall return)
What returns shall not be made smaller
Than what departed first

Copper lifts under the thaw,
green at seam and split at jaw.
Moss keeps watch on fencepost nails,
slow as weather, old as tales.

Glass of frost in the ditchline cracks,
sparrows stitch the air in tracks.
Smoke unthreads from chimney stone,
comes back smaller, comes back
known.

At the center, no name, no face,
only a pulse in the empty place.
Only hush with a living sheen,
where the dark and bright are seen.

Salt and ember, reed and wire,
mud remembers the first small fire.
What was driven from the field
returns with mud still on the heel.

Iron wakes beneath the rain,
red with root and old refrain.
Bone keeps count beneath the hill,
soil drinks deep and gathers still.

Flame bends low where night has lain,
takes the black and gives back grain.
Ash turns gold beneath the loam,
darkness enters, light comes home.

At the center, no face, no crown,
only weight that draws all down.
Only silence, deep and bright,
shadow folded into light.

Iron, bone, and breathing clay,
flame shall eat the dusk away.
What went outward, worn and wild,
comes back quiet, reconciled.

Under thorn and under stone,

roots make scripture out of bone.
Every hollow, every scar,
feeds the fire beneath the star.

Coal remembers buried trees.
Rust remembers ancient seas.
Soil remembers every tread.
Flame makes lanterns of the dead.

Under cattail, under beam,
roots keep learning how to dream.
Copper lifts under the thaw,
green at seam and split at jaw.

Moss keeps watch on fencepost nails,
slow as weather, old as tales.

No shade severed from the blaze.
No lost foot beyond the ways.
Blackened branch and whitening coal
share one ember, share one whole.

Strike the iron. Wake the ground.
Lift the marrow into sound.
Let the furrow hold the spark.
Let the brightness drink the dark.

Bone to soil and soil to flame,
flame to iron without name.
Iron cooling, dark made clear,
light made heavy, silence near.

At the center, still and whole,
root beneath the root of soul.
Neither ruler, flesh, nor form,
only hearth where worlds are born.

In the epoch before the Lila,
before river, root, or breath,
the Weaver stirred within the void
where birth lay folded into death.
From Akasha rose one Jiva,
a coal no dark could destroy.
"Go forth," the Weaver whispered,
and silence found a voice.

Behold the center, without image,
without throne,
the steadfast No that guards the living
Yes.
A fortress wrought of silence,
a door no hunger may possess.

The Sabbath lamp burns by the
crescent.
The qibla turns through rain.
The Tao runs under broken bridges.
The Vedas wake in grain.

Keep this threshold unbroken.

Down the Witch's road,
where thorn trees lean to listen,
where the way runs wild and wicked
and the moon keeps hidden fire.
One hand bears the lamp of Judah,
one lifts the desert flame.
Between the wheel and water,
Magic keeps the hidden name.

Hand of the Light and Dark,
born where ember answers dawn,
fire beneath illumination,
root below and rising sun.
The Yes within the open palm,
the No engraved beneath,
the breath that kindles every gate,
the sword that shelters peace.

We are the weavers of heaven.
We are the knights of the seam,
crossing woods where old worlds sleep,
carrying salt through the dream.
Watch every step through Samsara.
The circle remembers the tread.
No road is only departure.
No gate belongs to the dead.

Bone in the milestone,
blood in the briar,
black wings passing
through pillars of fire.
A crown made bright by falling,
a lantern raised below,
the Morning Star in the cavern
teaching buried light to grow.

No tyrant seated over darkness,
no servant chained beneath the sun.
The Witch is Hand of both horizons,
where severed fires are one.
Above is written into Below.
Below gives Above a name.
Shadow enters illumination.
Light remembers flame.

I came to gates of gold.
I came through iron and bone,
seeking the face of the Witness
already waiting at home.
Jacob's ladder crossed the branches.
The crescent silvered the well.
The uncarved block lay by the altar.
The conch woke in the shell.

Sacred refusal shaped the blessing.
Hidden mercy answered clear.
The river yielded, still remaining.
The Vedas moved within the ear.

The Great Spindle has stopped,

but the thread is not severed.

yet the turning enters forever.
The last foot falls through fracture
where the vanished floor runs deep.
What was becoming enters ember.
What enters ember shall keep.

Hand that acts, vessel that holds,
flame that opens the threefold fold.
Tat Tvam Asi,
the wanderer's answer.
Never in exile.
The wandering was never exile.

At the leftward gate stands shadow.
At the rightward gate stands light.
Between them walks the Witch of
Always,
dawn beneath the cloak of night.
Not divided by the darkness,
not consumed within the blaze,
the self-begotten emanation
where No and Yes behold one face.

Down the Witch's road,
past djinn in cedar hollow,
past the angel at the threshold,
past the white hart none may follow.
Through the orchard of Shekhinah,
through the garden after rain,
through the turning wheel of Dharma,
through the Tao that leaves no stain.

Keep this threshold unbroken.

The Garden waits before the traveler.
The Garden rises behind.
Nothing falls beyond the covenant.
Nothing is lost to time.
Every thirst becomes a fountain.
Every wound reveals a door.

Every shadow brought to lantern
knows its shape once more.

The road listened to each footfall.
The Weaver was the way.
The wound became hidden scripture.
The thunder learned to pray.
Tat Tvam Asi,
the name beneath all names,
the ember left when crowns are dust,
the light remembered in flame.

A kitchen light at midnight
Blue-white over the sink
A kettle starting up
Low hum under the floorboards
The first step out the door
With the coat still half-buttoned
When the road still feels like work
And the hands still smell like soap

One step, one breath
Then another through the hush
Hands still moving, scarred
Still knowing how to mend
Rising with the birds
Before the street wakes up
Still carrying the same old spark
Under thumb, under ash

The great wheel catches its turning
Hear the breath in the quiet
The thread of everlasting is wound
Tight through the ring of the morning
star
Not ended by ruin
Not cut by a blade
But brought back to the ground
Back to the grain, back to the table

Down, down, down the road
(Down the Witches' Road)
Down, down, down the road
(Blood and tears and bone)
Down past the hedges
Past the ditch with the nettles
Past the gate with the bent wire
Past the names on the stones

Maiden, Mother, Crone
Maiden, Mother, Crone
Three faces at the table
Three bowls, three spoons, three chairs
And a chair left in the cold

For the one who comes late
For the one who stays
For the one who learns the shape of
absence

Made a home from scraps
From a door that stuck in winter
A harbor from the storm
Salt on the sill, boards creaking
Kettle on the back burner
Steam ghosting the window
Mending shirts by dawn
Needle in, needle out

Even when the name
Felt far away
Like a coin at the bottom of a coat
The Road kept every footstep
Kept the dust, kept the turning
Turning in the clay
Turning in the seams of the hands

Built of breath
The houses rise
Plaster walls of silence
Cracked by laughter, smoke, and
waiting
Where old voices gather
Under eaves and behind the frame
One by one, alive
In the rafters, in the kettle song

Burn
Spirit in the fire
Witch of Always
Ash and iron, salt and skin
Flesh is called
Casting the circle
Walked the Witches' Road
Step by step
Stone by stone
Down the road

Wicked and winding
Blackthorn, broom, and bramble

Rest now
Let the dawn come in
Thin gold on the table
Soft feet on the stair
One soft chord
One slow breath
One open hand
And healing begins

Not forgotten
Not for nothing
Every cup, every scar
Every lock of hair in the comb
All that has been carried
Still came back as love
Back as supper, back as shelter
Back as the door left unlatched

Hold the feather, hold the flame
Hold the thread between the fingers
Even when the house is changed
Even when the walls are new
Own the night
Where the broken still remain
Love remembers every name
Writes them into the threshold

Own the night

He walked the Witches' Road
Past the hawthorn and the creek bed
Past the bone-white moon in the ditch
Past the orchard split with winter

She lived in his flame
Kept the ember under breath
Kept the match in the sleeve
Kept the warmth in the dark

The last footprint found the first stone
At the end of the lane
At the start of the circle
Where the ground knew the pattern

And both bore the same name
Spoken low at the table
Spoken once by the door
Spoken again in the morning

Wicked and winding
Follow me my friend
To the turning
Past the bend

And the world comes to an end again